

Backup Alternative to Claude Workspace

Assessment & recommendation — NIT-6002

Ticket	NIT-6002 — QC Automation: Identify and document backup alternative to Claude Workspace
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Status	Draft for review

1. Background / concern

Claude Workspace (Claude Cowork) has been flagged as an area of concern for HUB24: as a full desktop agent it is broad and powerful, and it is not approved for use on the project. This document identifies a backup / alternative tool so the QC automation work can continue safely.

2. Primary alternative — Claude Code (approved)

- Same underlying Claude engine as Cowork, but runs inside the repository via the CLI / IDE instead of a broad desktop agent.
- Restricted for security by a managed settings.json: sandboxed execution, allow-listed commands only, cannot read secrets/.env, network allow-list, full audit/telemetry, and managed MCP servers only.
- Covers the core need: authoring and maintaining the automation, generating test cases, and running the test suite.

3. Additional fallbacks

- **Claude Desktop** — arriving later; a lighter desktop assistant on the same engine; use once approved.

4. Key point — the QC pipeline does not depend on Claude at runtime

The automation itself (Playwright + TypeScript + npm, run in CI / CloudBees) and the automatic bug → Jira reporter (Jira REST API + token) execute on their own. Claude is used only to author / generate. So even if every Claude tool were unavailable, the existing test suite still runs in CI and still logs defects. Claude is an accelerator, not a runtime dependency — which directly mitigates the concern.

5. Comparison

Tool	Role	Approval / security	Availability
Claude Cowork (Workspace)	Full desktop agent	Not approved — flagged	Blocked
Claude Code	Authoring, generation, run tests	Approved — sandboxed (settings.json)	Being provisioned
Claude Desktop	Lighter desktop assistant	To be approved later	Later

6. Recommendation

- **Primary backup / alternative:** Claude Code (approved, restricted).
- **Secondary:** Claude Desktop when available.
- **Resilience:** the QC pipeline runs without any Claude tool at runtime, so delivery is not blocked if a tool is unavailable.

7. Dependencies (to make Claude Code the working alternative)

- Provision Claude Code access; add the required network allow-list domains; use a HUB24 Jira account + valid API token. (See the QC Automation Plan for details.)